



Historic feat: Swapnil Kusale made history by winning India's first Olympic bronze in the 50m men's three-position event at Châteauroux, becoming Maharashtra's first individual medallist since KD Jadhav's 1952 wrestling bronze. RITU RAJ KONWAR

Going purely by count and not the colour of medals, India had already equalled its London 2012 showing. But Swapnil Kusale's chef d'oeuvre in smallbore ensured India went above and beyond.

Although the 50m 3 positions rifle shooter from Maharashtra somehow managed to squeeze through to the final with a seventh-place finish

during qualifying, he consistently fired at the 10-ring in 'Standing' later to ensure another medal — a bronze.

So close yet so far

India, which had failed to open its account in Tokyo 2020, finished 14th on the shooting medal tally. China defended the top spot, finishing with